College football picks (2026-10-16)

Engine (official) and framework side by side. All times Phoenix.

Kickoff	Game	Engine (official)	Framework	Framework score
Fri 4:30 PM	Memphis at Tulane	No pick (both): QB change: freshman Trace Johnson to start per sources (Fox 8 New Orleans, Oct 16), not confirmed by Tulane; even if confirmed, a first start with very little playing time (5 pass attempts this season, in relief vs Southern Miss on Sep 26); Kadin Semonza started the last 4 and coach Will Hall called the job open (Oct 13)		
Fri 5:00 PM	App State at Coastal Carolina	No pick (both): Malachi Singleton (ankle) game-time decision (questionable since Oct 13, hurt vs Old Dominion); Henry Hasselbeck starts if he can't		
Fri 5:00 PM	Washington at Purdue	No pick (both): Demond Williams Jr. (rib) out vs Purdue; Elijah Brown starts (ESPN sources, CBS, Oct 16)		

They agree on 0 of 0 picks (green) and split on 0 (amber). Bold = 70%+. Grey = no pick. No pick: the starting QB is out or unconfirmed, or a team lacks enough play-by-play this season.

How far to trust them (college, same games). 2025: 580 games, engine 70.9%, framework 67.9%; 2026: 142 games, engine 67.6%, framework 65.5%.

Engine: the locked college method (NFL: with the approved NFL settings), rating every offense and defense on EPA and success rate, adjusted for opponents. Framework: your Prompt Football criteria (trenches 25%, net efficiency 25%, passing 20%, situational 15%, high leverage 15%) scored from this season's play-by-play only. Files: results/ in the sports-engines repo.